



run by adolescent interns to being a campaign orchestrated by an AI. Clients such as Le Monde, Le Figaro, Axel Springer, and San Jose Mercury News are all seeing the benefits of using Echobox.

02

VIV LABS

In 2016, Samsung agreed to acquire Viv – an assistant system created by the same people who made Siri. When one reads a sentence like that, the first question that comes to mind is, “How is it different



from Siri?” Well, the difference is twofold: First, it allows for more complex, conversational queries because it assimilates the information gathered by all the different applications on the phone to interlink into one vast web of information it can work on. Secondly, because it can literally write its own code, Viv can create and apply new programs without ever having heard of them before. Its founders say that Viv is a “software that builds itself”. Watch the impressive launch video here: <http://dgit.in/SiriViv>

03

MAD STREET DEN

Launched in 2013 by wife-husband duo Ashwini and Anand Chandrasekaran, Mad Street Den was originally based out of Chennai. Within its ranks, Mad Street Den has a fascinating group of Data Scientists, Neurologists, Designers, and all round computer geniuses. They aim to build a visual identifica-

tion intelligence so that the fashion and lifestyle industry is able to better customer relations. They want to also build tools to accurately understand and predict the way a customer behaves, thereby giving the corporation a competitive advantage.



This is a relatively newer startup that acquired their seed funding in 2016. However, helmed by a CMU graduate, it has the potential to become a global entity. Already it has physical representation in Europe, the US, and India. Here’s a video about them: <http://dgit.in/MSDSsystems>



04

BANJO

This startup has a really bold aim – to create an Alexandrian Library worth of information via social media. It was founded in 2013 after the Boston Marathon bombings, and sounds like the real world manifestation of the AI that controls everything in Jonathan Nolan’s Person of Interest. Creating a web of information that includes Facebook, Twitter, Russia’s VKontakte, and China’s Weibo, it can classify locations and photos to quite



literally ‘rewind’ the flow of information to accurately plot past events.

Take for example, a terrorist attack. Banjo could be used to create a blueprint of the situation using the millions of social media updates available to it. It would essentially be able to play with our fourth dimension whenever it pleases.

05

DEFINED CROWD

Siri, Cortana, and the aforementioned Viv all need millions of hours of well curated language input. Defined Crowd is filling this niche need by creating complicated pipelines that accurately filter and interpret data. This is done partly through their AI, and partly through actual real human beings. Amy Du, Co-founder and CEO, said that there is a very subtle difference between an excited tweet and a happy tweet. This is where the company’s crowdsourcing ability comes in. They’re already in almost 50 countries with 50-100 people working on language data in each of these countries. After the initial kinks are ironed out from each country and their human workforce start delivering consistently, they receive almost real time information about the language.

